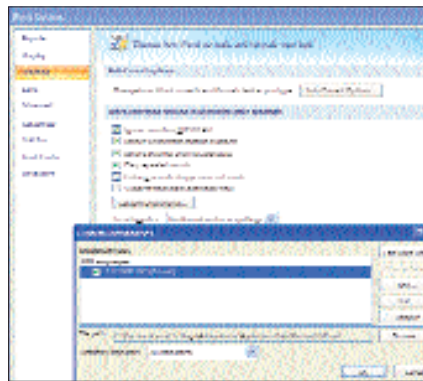


you go on creating new workbooks and spreadsheets. There is an option available to change that name. Click on the Office Button, and in the Popular section, at the bottom you will find a text entry space to change the name.



Add Custom Dictionaries

When the default dictionary that comes along with Microsoft Office isn't doing its job as you want it, you can



Adding your own custom dictionaries

always refer to other dictionaries. Dictionary files can be set up for Excel in a few easy steps. In Office 2007, first click on the Office Button. Then click on the Excel options. Click on Proofing and you will find a button saying Custom Dictionaries. Clicking on it will load a small window with options to create your own, new dictionary of words or even load existing, downloaded dictionaries.



Embedding Fonts

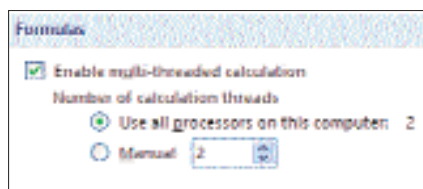
Excel usually doesn't let you embed fonts into your documents, so mostly likely the people opening up the spreadsheets won't see them either. The trick is to embed your Excel elements into a normal Word file and send it to people. This way, people can finally see the Excel spreadsheet with the fonts you intended to show, but they'll have to use Word to view them.



Multi-core Power For Excel?!

Yes, Excel 2007 gives you the option to use your dual-core processors to speed up your work. Sure, the performance gain won't be very noticeable. But if you do have a dual-core processor, you might as well take some advantage of it.

Head off to the Office Button. Then,



Excel actually "supports" multi-core!

scroll down till you see a Formulas section. You will find an option to enable multi-threaded calculations, or manually choose the number of processors on your machine.



No More Blank Spreadsheets!

Every time you load up Excel, you stare at a blank workbook which you then close and open your existing workbook. If you want no workbooks starting up by default, you can do so by adding a "/e" parameter to your Excel startup.

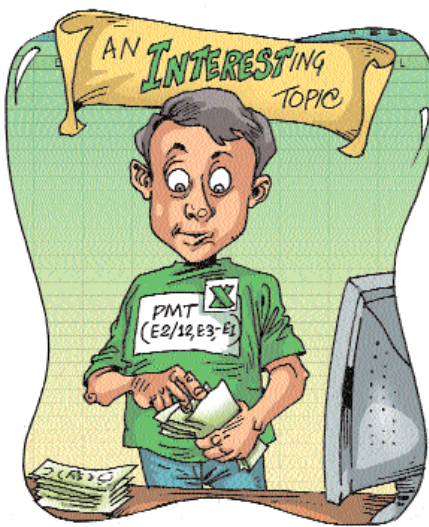
To do this, you can create a new shortcut. Choose the location where

you want to create the shortcut, the Desktop for example. Right-click on the Desktop and click on New and then on Shortcut.

Click Browse and locate your Office installation. We use Office 2007, so our Excel EXE was located in C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office12. Click on EXCEL.EXE and Click OK. Add a "/e" at the end of the path such that the location is "C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\Office12\Excel.exe" /e.

Double-click on the shortcut, and Excel will load up without any open worksheets. ■

EXCEL FORMULAS



Addition / Subtraction

These functions, while not being exactly formulas, are the most basic functions used in Excel and have been included here for the sake of those new to formulas. Needless to say, any Excel file with formulas will contain these basic functions the most. You can perform addition or subtraction between data located in cells. For example, if you want the total of all numbers in cells A1, A2, A3 and D6, and you want to subtract the total with a number situated in cell D8, and you want the grand total to be displayed in cell F10, you can do so by going to cell F10 and typing in

=A1+A2+A3+D6-D8

Note that when you change the data in any of the cells F10 mentions, then the result will change on its own without requiring you to recalculate the result. Like in the example above, you can use mathematical functions randomly, that is, you can add the data in cells A1 and A2, and subtract the result with the data in cell D6—just change the "+" sign to "-" when you need it. A small tip: if your formula consists only of additions, you can use the SUM function instead of putting in the plus sign between the cell numbers:

=SUM(A1:A6)

This will give the sum of the values entered in the cells A1 to A6. Should you need to add in another cell that isn't sequential, for example, you also need the add the data in cell D7 in addition to the above, you can enter in the following:

=SUM(A1:A6, D7)

There, a comma is all that's needed if you need to add more cells to the formula. This method of including cells is valid for any other formulas you work with.

A thing to remember is that you can also use constants at any time when needed in your formulas. For example,

Everyone is familiar with Excel, the most popular spreadsheet program ever. However, what makes Excel truly stand out is its ability to support a wide range of formulas. If it weren't for Excel supporting formulas, we would still be stuck spending half the time [Alt] + [Tab]-bing back to Calculator, all because you made a minor change in your spreadsheet.

Most use only the most basic formulas; few are aware of the rather wide range Excel supports. We'll be covering most formulas you can use with Excel; some you will use often, while some you will use rarely, depending on your needs. These formulas are tested thoroughly on Excel 2007, and though just a few, we have included Excel 2007-specific formulas as well.

Basic Formulas

These are formulas which aren't too complicated and are easy to remember. Also, these are what you will be using the most in your spreadsheets. The first few, while being rather simple, are included to help you get a feel of things.